

Tobias Treppmann

The last stretch of a consumer experience is a design-technology problem now. Assistants write the first draft, and their output compiles, renders, and is quietly off-system

CONTACT

LOCATION

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
2022 - 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 - 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 - Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

I lead design functions, and the last year went into the layer underneath the craft. At Bibel TV I own UI quality across iOS, Android, web and connected TV. I prototype in real code against real production APIs and engineering ships from that code. Around 70% of it reaches production. The quality bar is enforced by the build rather than by review. Six checks refuse work that has left the system, and over a library believed clean they identified 32 off-system values. Before that I ran design at Ninox and design for five years at Datameer.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 - Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV; engineering supplied by an external agency) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- The quality bar, implemented — six checks that run identically on a laptop and in CI. Two reject what an AI assistant produces: a token reference that does not resolve, and a color hardcoded into a component. Both render, so review never catches them. Over a library believed clean they identified 32 off-system values.
- Design to code, across a company boundary — I prototype in real code against real production APIs, web first and then Android. Engineering is an external agency and ships from that code. Around 70% reaches production directly or with minor modification, and iteration moved from days to hours.
- Modern UI foundations — DTCG tokens in three tiers from global primitives through semantic to component, built with Style Dictionary and synced live to Figma and Android. One commit propagates to every platform, so the high-quality choice is also the fast one.
- Craft at the pixel, owned as an algorithm — a color engine using k-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB, so artwork-driven themes carry even perceptual weight across a grid. Text is validated against base with the WCAG algorithm until the pair passes.
- An AI practice with a stated bar — agentic engineering introduced from zero at Bibel TV, with the enforcement layer built alongside it. The token vocabulary goes to the assistant as an enumerated list rather than from memory, so it cannot invent one.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 - 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Two functions at once, nine reports, four disciplines — from July to October 2023 I held Product Design and Product together. Design was five, split between product design and UX writing, including a design lead. Product was three product managers and a data scientist. Senior Leadership Team throughout.
- Hired 2, promoted 2 — including the consultant who then took Head of Product permanently. Coached the design lead through a strained engineering relationship. Ten years reviewing and critiquing designers' work as a senior mentor at CareerFoundry alongside the day job.
- Design made co-equal by agreement rather than assertion — a collaborative UX-maturity self-assessment run with product and engineering, after which design held parity in planning. Shared design-system governance across four designers and engineering, motion included as custom easing curves.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 - 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP — ~50 people, DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Advocating for the right build, through delivery — the internal plan for a client-funded booking project was a standalone add-on module. I delivered a capability embedded in the platform instead, general enough to carry the most-requested use cases. 70% coordination-time reduction and 90% acceptance at the launch customer, and it then shipped to every customer.
- Six markets, one product, under regulation — Germany, Denmark, the UK, Sweden, Norway and Switzerland. AI alt-text generation shipped for EU accessibility compliance, under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law. We audited our own website and also the websites customers build with the platform, for EU Accessibility Act compliance.

Director of Design

2016 - 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- A functional head among functional heads — I led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years, trading scope with product and engineering counterparts. I defined component behavior and specs across the library, motion included as custom easing curves, and the UI designers executed the visual system.
- Five years of data-dense interfaces — pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards and filter logic. Pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach analysts working inside regulated banks and insurers.

UX Strategy Lead

2014 - 2016

Spreadshirt (international e-commerce, hundreds of thousands of consumers — 200+ people) · Leipzig, Germany

- Shipped what the company had twice failed to ship — a nine-month seller-experience redesign, after two previous attempts. Leadership wanted a 60-second automated journey. Interviews with shop owners found the design step was the part they valued most. The strategy moved to automation that preserves control, and the mobile designer prototype went to production.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade reviewing and critiquing designers' work

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport hub SE* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

SKILLS

Design Technology and the Design-Engineering Boundary

Prototypes built in real code against real production APIs, web first and then Android, with an external engineering agency shipping from that code · Around 70% of the AI-generated code reaches production directly or with minor modification, and iteration moved from days to hours · DTCG tokens in three tiers with Style Dictionary and live sync to Figma and Android · Storybook as the source of truth with a prototyping layer on top · Component behavior and specs across the Datameer library, where the UI designers executed the visual system

AI-Native Practice, and the Bar It Has to Meet

Six checks that run identically on a laptop and in CI and refuse off-system work · They reject a token reference that does not resolve and a color, size or duration hardcoded into a component · Both compile and render, so neither is caught by tests or review · 32 off-system values identified in a library believed clean after two cleanup passes · The token vocabulary handed to the assistant as an enumerated list rather than recalled, so it cannot invent · Figma, Claude Code, Claude skills, Cursor and Zed as daily tools

Craft and Quality

A color engine live in production, with k-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB so artwork-driven themes carry even perceptual weight across a grid · Text validated against base with the WCAG algorithm until the pair passes, so nothing ships failing contrast · Motion carried by the design system as custom easing curves at Ninox and Datameer rather than as per-screen animation · Selah — Mindful Transitions: a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store

Leading, Hiring and Critique

Product Design and Product held together at Ninox from July to October 2023 · Nine reports across four disciplines — product design, UX writing, product management and data science · Senior Leadership Team · Hired two, promoted two · Coached the design lead through a strained engineering relationship · A functional head among functional heads at Datameer, leading the design team across Germany and NYC for five years · Ten years reviewing and critiquing designers' work as a senior mentor at CareerFoundry

Owning a Domain, and Raising the Bar Across It

At Bibel TV the domain is UI quality across four platforms. The bar is raised by what the build refuses rather than by who is reviewing · Discovery and execution are one loop, because the prototype is the artifact and the detail survives the handoff instead of being redrawn from a spec · At ChurchDesk the internal plan was a standalone add-on module. I delivered an embedded platform capability instead, which cut coordination time by 70% with 90% acceptance and then shipped to every customer · At Spreadshirt, the nine-month seller-experience redesign that shipped after two previous company attempts had failed

Consistency at Scale, and the Systems Thinking Under It

One product across six countries at ChurchDesk, under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law · Localized product and documentation across DACH, the UK and the US at Ninox, and across the US, Canada and the UK at Datameer · Consistency across iOS, Android, web and connected TV held from a single token source, so it survives content nobody has seen yet · Systems thinking is what makes a shared visual language scale without a person policing it

Advocacy and First Principles

The ChurchDesk architecture call, defended from plan through delivery · At Spreadshirt, interviews with shop owners moved product strategy away from a 60-second automated journey to automation that preserves control · Design established as co-equal with product and engineering at Ninox through a collaborative self-assessment rather than an imposed model · Service-to-product transformation with Hypoport's executive team